

HONOURED

BASIC WORD TRACKER

Developer Scope — Three Writing Programs — One Milestone — 30 Hours Maximum — for Jimmy — Updated Sept 2026

Sign it. Keep it. Become it.

Core privacy principle

Verify that the writing commitment was kept. The writing is counted on the user's device and is never stored, uploaded, logged or seen. Only the number leaves the counting step.

The tracker verifies numeric word-count progress in one user-selected writing source for a Honoured contract. It is not a writing assistant, editor, keylogger or manuscript-analysis feature.

1. Platform

- Honoured runs on iOS. This feature is built inside the Honoured iPhone app. **No Mac, Windows or browser companion app is in scope.**
- File-based sources are accessed through the iOS Files app document picker (iCloud Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive and other file providers), using security-scoped access to the one item the user selects.
- Users may write on a Mac or PC. Honoured sees their words once the source has synced to the cloud (see Sync timing, section 5).

2. Objective

Example contract: "Write 500 words today." Honoured records the selected document or project's starting word count, checks it again during or at completion, calculates the net increase, and returns only the verification result to Honoured.

3. Single-milestone delivery

This project is completed as one milestone. The developer begins with a short technical investigation of the three target applications, then proceeds directly into implementation, integration, testing and polish within the same milestone. The investigation is part of the milestone, not a separate payment or delivery. The milestone is capped at 30 hours.

Minimum delivery

- Required:** Microsoft Word and TextEdit. These must be delivered for the milestone to be accepted.
- Delivered unless a blocker is proven:** Scrivener. If the investigation shows a material technical blocker, the developer must flag it in writing with the reason and an estimate of additional effort **before the milestone is accepted**. The work is not expanded without agreement.

4. Target applications

Application	Tier	Initial target	Developer note
Microsoft Word	Required	Selected .docx file	A .docx is a zipped XML package — open and count locally. Never read unrelated Word documents.
TextEdit	Required	Selected .txt / .rtf file	Test plain and rich text separately. Count visible writing only.
Scrivener	Unless blocked	Selected .scriv project	A project is a folder of many text files plus research and snapshots. Count only the manuscript (Draft folder) and total it. Validate stable counts after moves/renames.

Planned for a future version

- **Apple Pages, Google Docs and iA Writer** will be added in a future version. Pages uses a closed, undocumented file format; Google Docs requires Google sign-in plus Google's OAuth app verification review, which can take weeks; iA Writer (plain-text/Markdown files) is deferred to keep this milestone within 30 hours.
 - During this milestone's investigation, include a brief written note (no build) on whether Pages word counts look achievable on-device. This informs the future version's scope.
 - Build the common verification layer and source adapters so that Pages, Google Docs and iA Writer can be added later as new adapters without reworking the core.
-

5. Functional requirements

- User chooses exactly one supported writing document/project for the contract.
- Record the starting word count at contract activation.
- Store a stable document/project identifier sufficient to find the same source again.
- Re-check the current count periodically and/or when the contract is evaluated.
- Calculate net progress: current count minus starting count.
- Return numeric progress and verification state to Honoured.
- Mark the contract achieved when the required net increase is reached, subject to Honoured's existing contract rules.
- Handle permission denied, source unavailable, file moved/renamed, source application unavailable and count unavailable.
- Never count writing from unrelated email, browser searches, messages, ChatGPT or other documents.

The Oath — recurring word contracts

- When the word tracker is used with an Oath (e.g. "Write 500 words every Tue, Thu, Sat, Sun for 1 month"), a **new baseline is taken at the start of each Oath day**.
- Each Oath day is verified on its own net increase. Words written on one Oath day never count toward another. Non-Oath days are not tracked.
- Oath day results feed the same HONoured / BROKEN / AMENDED logic defined in The Oath scope.

Counting behaviour

The Basic Tracker is a net-count tracker. Example: start 10,000 words, finish 10,500 words = +500 verified words. If the writer adds 800 words and deletes 300, this version may report +500. Reconstructing every word typed is outside scope.

Counting consistency

Use one deterministic counting method for baseline and later checks. If Honoured's count differs slightly from an application's displayed count because of punctuation, headings, metadata, Markdown or other formatting, document the rule and apply it consistently.

Sync timing

- For cloud-synced sources, words written on a Mac or PC reach Honoured only after syncing.
 - If the count is short at the deadline, Honoured requests a fresh copy and re-checks within a short grace window (suggested 30 minutes) before stamping the day BROKEN.
 - Words found in the grace window count only if the source's last-modified time is before the deadline.
 - A temporary read or sync failure must never silently become a BROKEN day — show a clear retry/re-authorise state instead.
-

6. Privacy and security requirements

- Writing is counted on the user's device only. Manuscript text is never uploaded, retained, logged, indexed or analysed.
- Persist only minimum verification metadata: source identifier, source type, timestamps, baseline count, current count, target count and verification status.
- Never transmit manuscript content to Honoured's backend.
- Request the narrowest permissions technically possible. The user must explicitly select/authorise the one source being tracked.
- Do not monitor keyboard input, clipboard contents, unrelated folders, browser activity or other applications.
- Logs, crash reports and analytics must never contain manuscript excerpts or document content.
- User-facing wording: *"Your writing is counted on your device and never stored, uploaded or seen."*

7. Suggested implementation architecture

Use one common verification layer with small source adapters, rather than separate independent trackers. This also allows Pages, Google Docs and iA Writer to be added later as new adapters. Each adapter locates the selected source, obtains a reliable current count and returns a standard error state when it cannot.

Component	Responsibility
Source picker / authorisation	User nominates one document/project through the Files picker and grants only required access.
Source adapter	Application-specific method for reading the source and obtaining a count.
Count normaliser	Consistent word-count rules where Honoured performs the count.
Baseline store	Persist source identifier + numeric baseline (per Oath day where applicable). No manuscript text.
Verifier	Re-check count, apply sync grace window, calculate current minus baseline.
Honoured bridge	Return progress, achieved/not achieved, timestamp and error state.
Error layer	Permission, missing source, renamed/moved, offline/cloud unavailable, unsupported format.

8. UX flow

- **Setup:** Choose Word Tracker, choose writing application, select one document/project, obtain baseline, confirm starting count and tracking status.
- **During contract:** Show numeric progress only, e.g. '327 / 500 words'. Never display manuscript text.
- **Completion:** Re-check source (with sync grace window), calculate net increase, return achieved/not achieved, update the Honoured contract.
- **Error:** Explain the problem and offer retry / re-authorise / reselect.

9. Edge cases to test

- Document renamed or moved after baseline. Two documents with the same filename.
- Document duplicated — the duplicate must not silently become the tracked original.
- Source not yet synced at the deadline; cloud source temporarily offline.
- Permission revoked after setup.
- Empty document, very large manuscript, non-English Unicode text, punctuation-heavy prose, headings, lists and Markdown.
- Honoured closed or restarted; phone restarted; source application updated.
- Oath: baseline correctly resets at the start of each Oath day; non-Oath days ignored.

10. Expected developer effort — one milestone

Work allocation inside the single milestone, not separate milestones.

Workstream within the single milestone	Hours
Technical investigation across the 3 sources (+ brief Pages feasibility note)	3–4 h
Common source-selection / authorisation layer	3–4 h
Core baseline + net-count verification engine (incl. sync grace window)	4–5 h
Word + TextEdit adapters	3–4 h
Scrivener adapter / project-count validation	3–4 h
Honoured integration + Oath per-day baseline + UI/error states	3–4 h

Workstream within the single milestone	Hours
Testing, edge cases and polish	4–5 h
Expected total (30 hours maximum)	23–30 h

11. Acceptance criteria

- Word and TextEdit each pass baseline and re-check verification on representative test documents.
- Scrivener passes verification, **or** has a written blocker report with reason and additional-effort estimate, provided before acceptance.
- A +500 net increase is reported as +500 without retaining manuscript text. Only the selected source contributes to progress.
- Oath contracts take a fresh baseline each Oath day.
- Closing/reopening Honoured does not lose the baseline or selected-source identity.
- Permission, sync and missing-source failures produce understandable error states and never silently fail a contract.
- No manuscript text appears in logs, analytics, crash reports or backend payloads.
- Integrated into Honoured, tested and polished within the same milestone.

12. Explicitly out of scope

- Mac, Windows or browser companion apps.
- True words-written reconstruction after deletions or revisions.
- Keystroke monitoring or global writing detection.
- Fine-grained edit history and anti-double-counting event reconstruction.
- Reading, summarising, analysing or AI-processing manuscript content.
- Complex cross-device/offline conflict recovery.
- Tracking multiple manuscripts simultaneously for one contract.
- Apple Pages, Google Docs and iA Writer — planned for a future version.
- Writing applications beyond the three listed above without a scope change.

13. Work sequence and handoff

Technical validation, core tracker, required adapters (Word, TextEdit), Scrivener adapter, Honoured and Oath integration, testing and polish. This is a development sequence only — not separate milestones, payments or deliverables.

Handoff note: The priority is reliability and privacy. Honoured only needs to know whether the user's writing commitment was kept. If a source cannot provide a trustworthy numeric count without invasive monitoring or manuscript retention, flag it before changing the privacy model or expanding the agreed scope.